

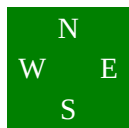
Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 3
 ♥ Q 9 8
 ♦ A 7 3
 ♣ 10 8 5 4

♠ K Q J
 ♥ A K 7 3
 ♦ Q 10 9 4
 ♣ 7 3



♠ 10 8 7 6 2
 ♥ 10 5 4
 ♦ K 6
 ♣ J 9 6

♠ 5 4
 ♥ J 6 2
 ♦ J 8 5 2
 ♣ A K Q 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

started with 5 ♠s. And the fall of North's ♠s looks like he may have 1 ♠ left, very likely the ♠K.

All this means that you should take your ♦A now and return your last ♠ to establish East's suit. Now East's ♦K will be an entry to the ♠s

If you play low, East will have to take the ♦K now, and although he can play a ♠ to establish the suit, he will not have an entry to be able to cash them.

[showcards N:D2]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠6. You won the ♠A and returned the ♠9, won by North's ♠Q.

North next played to dummy's ♣A and led the ♦2. What do you play?

Play the ♦A.

Count the points. North's 15-17 plus South's 11 plus your 10 comes to 36-38. So East has room for an Ace or a King, but no more.

East's second ♠ play was the 2, so it looks like he started with 5 ♠s. And the fall of North's ♠s looks like he may have 1 ♠ left, very likely the ♠K.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 8 6
 ♥ K 7 5 3
 ♦ A Q 5
 ♣ 8 4

♠ 5 2

♥ Q J 10

♦ J 9 8 2

♣ 9 6 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 10 7 3

♥ 9 8 6 4

♦ K 7

♣ A K

♠ 9 4

♥ A 2

♦ 10 6 4 3

♣ Q J 10 7 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
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		1 ♠	Pass
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2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥	Pass
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4 ♠	Pass	6 ♠	
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All Pass

6 ♠ by East

out of ♣s, just remember the bidding - he must have had 5 ♠s and 4 ♥s.

Suppose you play low on this ♥ (as East hopes you will). Dummy's ♥K will take the trick, and when another ♥ is played you will have to win it with your now bare ♥A. You will then have to play a ♦ or a ♣, giving East a ruff and sluff.

But if you take your ♥A now, then exit with your ♥2, East can win the ♥K but will still have to lose a ♥ to North.

[showcards W:CQ]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣Q, North plays low and East wins the ♣A.

East pulls trumps in 2 rounds. He then takes the ♦K, ♦Q, ♦A, discarding a ♥ on the last one. Next he plays dummy's last ♣ to his ♣K.

Having done all this, East now plays a low ♥ from his hand. What do you play?

Play the ♥A.

If you followed what East was doing you will realize that he has eliminated both the ♦s and ♣s from both his hand and dummy. If it isn't clear that he is now